

PC gaming resetting, not restarting

According to CyberPowerPC India COO Vishal Parekh

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For years, India's gaming story has been told almost completely via the lens of a smartphone. However, there has been a visible shift. The conversations are no longer just about playing games.

To gain a more in depth understanding of how India's PC gaming landscape is evolving, we sat down with Vishal Parekh, COO, CyberPowerPC India. He talked about what the industry is experiencing currently. It is not a sudden or abrupt change but a gradual reset that has been steadily building up over time. 'This process of reset is not confined to just one year. It has already started. What has really changed is the kind of conversations gamers in India are having today,' he said.

Those conversations, he noted, are no longer centred around whether a Rs 40,000 machine can run a game. Instead, they are about progression. 'Earlier, people would ask which game to play and which machine to buy. Now they say, "I am playing Valorant, I am at this level, and the next game I want to try is this."

That shift tells you the consumer has evolved,' he added.

Talent is not India's problem India has never lacked gamers. It has struggled to convert that population into consistent esports success.

While the debate frequently revolves around talent and opportunity, Parekh believes the distinction is far more practical than philosophical. 'People underestimate how much inconsistent or underpowered setups can affect a player's gameplay. If you are training on compromised hardware, you are building your skills around limitations you didn't even realise are there,' he added.

He explained that many aspiring players start their journey on machines built purely around budget constraints rather than long-term performance. 'When a gamer walks in, 99% of the time, the first conversation is about money. Not about the game they want to play or where they want to go,' he added.

That decision, he claims, has long-term implications. 'They practised for years on an 80 or 100Hz screen. Then they suddenly find themselves

in a competitive environment with 240Hz or 400Hz displays, faster RAM, and better cooling, and they feel lost. The game is technically the same, but the gaming experience is entirely different,' he added. At that moment, the problem is no longer just skill. It is more or less the conditioning.

Future-proofing is not optional any more

The past year has also prompted some really difficult discussions about pricing. GPU cycles have started accelerating, component costs have skyrocketed, and AI-driven workloads are quietly redefining what "performance" really means.

'Yes, pricing has become a challenge,' Parekh admitted. 'Previously, the difference was only about 5% here and there. Now you're seeing 300 to 400% increases in certain components,' he added.

But he believes that this pressure has also created buyers who are a lot more thoughtful. 'Previously, people would overbuy because they could. Today's conversation is more intelligent,' he claimed. 'You really need to ask yourself what you are going to do with your PC for the next three or four years,' he added.

Instead of just pushing straight for the absolute maximum specifications, he suggests a more modular approach. 'If you only play Valorant and have no plans to move on to AAA titles, why do you need the most powerful GPU available today? Start with what you need, then upgrade as your journey progresses,' he added.

This shift, he said, represents a shift away from luxury purchases and toward conscious investments. 'Future-proofing does not imply purchasing the most expensive parts. It entails not locking yourself into bad decisions,' he added. **[d]**



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